

Activity Report

Of

One Day Technical Workshop on

“ Current Status of Technical Assistance in Reconstruction and it's Challenges”



Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform-Nepal

HRRP

पुनर्निर्माणमा प्राविधिक सहयोगको अवस्था र चुनौती एक दिवसीय कार्यशाला गोष्ठी

One Day Technical Workshop on
Current Status of Technical Assistance in Reconstruction and it's Challenges

मिति: २०७३ माघ २५/February 7th, 2017 स्थान: GIZ/RPN

राष्ट्रिय पुनर्निर्माण प्राधिकरण
शहरी विकास मन्त्रालय, जिल्ला आयोजना कार्यान्वयन इकाई
आवास पुनर्लाभ तथा पुनर्निर्माण समन्वय मञ्च, नेपाल

National Reconstruction Authority (NRA)
District Level Program Implementation Unit (DLPIU)
Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform-Nepal (HRRP)

Under Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform-Nepal (HRRP)

Organizers : HRRP, Nuwakot



HRRP

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background

Nuwakot is one of highly affected districts by earthquake 2015. There are 61 VDCs and 1 Municipality in the district. There are 71,788 private structures of Damage Grade (3-5) and 5,630 housed are of Damage Grade (1-2) in the district. Eligible beneficiaries for grant in the district are 65,759 out of which 61,354 beneficiaries are enrolled and 60,474 beneficiaries received the first tranche. As per the NRA, only about 12% of beneficiaries received first tranche are reconstructing their houses.

There were 12 partner organizations working in housing and reconstruction in the district but now 8 partner organizations working.

HRRP is closely working with District NRA and DUDBC in the district. HRRP conducts coordination meeting twice a month in chairmanship of DUDBC and NRA where all POs in the district attend and share their activities and plans as well as issues and challenges. NRA and DUDBC in the facilitation of HRRP recommend and address the issues and challenges. Also, we analysed the gaps and request POs to fill the gaps as far as they could from their level. HRRP also updated 4Ws twice a month and prepare the information products and report which is used to submitting NRA and DUDBC twice a month.

HRRP realised the huge gap in technical assistances and duplication of technical assistances in Nuwakot district. One of the objectives of HRRP is to reduce gap and duplication of technical assistances in the district and to participate every beneficiaries enrolled in the reconstruction process for building earthquake resilient buildings. So, HRRP have decided for organizing the technical workshop which can be fruitful, participative and effective for reducing gaps and duplication in technical assistances and constraint in reconstruction in ward level.

1.2 Workshop Goal

Identify the reconstruction current status in the district

1.3 Workshop Objectives

- To share the POs experiences on the housing reconstruction and technical assistance.
- To collect the challenges on the Technical Assistance for safer reconstruction.
- To collect the ideas on possible improvement from field to provide the adequate Technical Assistance to ensure the safer reconstruction.
- To identify the gaps on the Technical Assistance in the District
- To identify the duplications and overlap on the Technical Assistance
- To evaluate the impact of IEC material developed and Disseminate by NRA and CLPIU

1.4 Workshop Participants

There were altogether 14 participants, 6 Engineers/Sub-Engineers and 7 Executive Officers from 7 POs and NRA head of districts who are responsible for housing reconstruction works in VDCs and municipalities present in the workshop. There were representative from all POs

currently working in recovery and reconstruction in the district apart from OXFAM in workshop.

Mr. Siddhartha Sharma, District Coordinator, HRRP was the co-ordinator and the Facilitator of the Workshop. Mr Sharma welcomed the participants of the workshop program and briefed about the workshop objectives and the expected output from the workshop. Mr.Sharma also briefed on the importance of the workshop and pledged the much needed participation from the participants.

The list of participants is included in Annex 1.

1.5 Workshop Schedule

One Day Technical Workshop on "Current Status of Technical Assistance in Reconstruction and it's Challenges"				
District : Nuwakot				
Date : 7 th February, 2017				
Venue : GIZ Hall, Balmandir, Bidur				
Time		Session	Description	Responsibility
9:00	9:30	S0	Registration	IM Assistant
9:30	9:45	S1	Opening Session : Introduction, Overview and Objective of Workshop, Group Photographs	HRRP District Coordinator
9:45	10:45	S2	Experience Sharing on Technical Assistances in the District from POs	POs/HRRP Team
10:45	11:45	S3	Evaluation of Reconstructed Houses w.r.t. Standard Operating Procedures (SOP), Nepal National Building Codes (NBC ** 2015), Updated Technical Guidelines and Overview on Published Documents by GON and its Current Implementation Status	DUDBC/DLPIU, NRA and District NSET
11:45	12:30		Break	
12:30	2:30	S4	Challenges in Technical Assistance in the Reconstruction Works Possible ideas to improve the technical assistance to make reconstruction more smooth and compliance standards (Group Work and Discussion)	POs
2:30	3:00	S0	Closing Session : Closing Remarks	(NRA, DLPIU, POs)

1.6 Methodology

- All the POs participated in the workshop shared their presentation sharing the experiences in technical assistances in the district. Click [here](#)
- NRA Head informed about the updated Technical Guidelines and also shared an overview on Published Documents by GON and its Current Implementation Status.
- District Technical Coordinator from district NSET presented about Evaluation of Reconstructed Houses w.r.t. Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) and Nepal National Building Codes (NBC ** 2015) in interaction and discussion approach. He also showed videos of dry machinery two story buildings vulnerability by shaking presentation which was held in China.
- Group Work and Discussion on Challenges in Technical Assistance in the Reconstruction Works and Possible ideas to improve the technical assistance to make reconstruction more smooth and compliance standards. Technical assistance with minimum six packages recommended by NRA are on which the discussions were more focussed during the workshop.

1.7 Contents

POs presented experience sharing presentation focussing contents mentioned below. The contents for presentation was provided by HRRP nuwakot to be more focussed on 6 TA recommended by NRA in workshop and according to objectives and agendas of the workshop.

- Program Overview of POs
- Working Procedure of POs
- Challenges and Experiences in TA

1.8 Workshop Output

- There was active participation of all POs currently working in recovery and reconstruction activities in the district.
- All POs shared challenges and experiences in 6 TA recommended by NRA.
- Possible ideas to overcome challenges discussed and noted which will be shared with NRA and DUDBC.
- NRA appreciated technical workshop as participative, communicative and fruitful and advised that such technical workshop should be organized time to time in near future.
- Confusion in SOP about some technical works cleared like SMM with active, one bay/two bay in construction and others
- Buildings codes and its implications in the field and some difficulties in implication discussed and cleared.

1.9 Major Challenges in the reconstruction and technical assistance

- Convincing communities due to inconsistency of information provided from POs and DLPIU engineers (Technical Assistance Team and Technical Inspection Team)
- How NGOs and INGOs are looked upon.
- Remoteness of the District
- Unavailability of good type of timber and high rates of other non local construction materials.
- A lot of the beneficiaries are motivated towards building either block masonry houses or truss structures as they are easier, faster and cheaper. However, the delay in the approved design is hindering the speed of construction.
- Cognitive Biasness among local people in VDC.
- A lot of the houses currently constructed do not comply with standards.
- Scarcity of masons, materials and water, problem in transportation, increasing rate of materials.(Example : Brick unit price was 15 each one month ago now hiked up to 19-20, like wise out masons are also not interested with existing wage rete).
- Very difficult to convince beneficiaries about approved design.
- Delay in second instalment recommendation and transfer of 2nd tranche.
- Lack of Monitoring and inspection by DLPIU engineers
- Government hasn't finalised the proper design and BOQ for RCC Houses which has compelled engineers to draw various design of RCC building with BOQ one by one making time consuming and also beneficiaries to extra cost and overtime for going to engineering consultancy making and approving the design
- NBC following in rural area is commendable but road standard and practices published by Road Department making dilemma and confusion among beneficiaries in reconstructing house and also feeling insecure thinking to be homeless in future.
- Beneficiaries not willing to comply with NBC code.
- Quality and Quantity of materials – owner driven model; Sometimes vendor/ suppliers cheated Beneficiaries in quality and quantity
- High Demand increases price of aggregate and labor
- Influence by political persons dialogue for using improper ratio of concrete, lesser quality of materials and not following SOP creating the possibility of reconstructing earthquake resilient houses.
- Relation between engineers/technical persons and masons needs to be improved
- Beneficiaries sticking with own design

- Height of floor & attic floor shouldn't be standard and better if can be slightly varied by engineer by own knowledge
- Still following traditional way to build houses
- Lack of sufficient money for construction
- Some technical issues (like SMM with attic is allowed or not) should be clearly mentioned as well as that of confusion about need of one bay or two bay for construction of two storeys and more than two storeys
- No instruction and guidelines on retrofitting and repair of already built houses
- Construction works has been slow as the people from community were not clear regarding the disbursement of second instalment.
- Lack of quality in locally produced bricks using in reconstruction
- Influence of political and social leaders in screening of masons which leads to production of unskilled masons
- Coordination lacking in between DLPIU engineers, VDC secretary and POs engineers
- There is no specific guidance from government authorities regarding on the Job Training model and curriculum. This is creating a dissimilarity between POs working in the sector.

1.10 Possible ideas to sort out the current challenges

- DDC and CDO office should coordinate for easy access of materials and prevention of unnecessary price hiking like that of aggregate, sands and wages etc
- DDC and CDO office in coordination with FNCCI must monitor quality of materials of reconstruction to assure the quality in reconstruction
- Urgent need of coordination meeting between partner organizations engineers and NRA engineers in lead of NRA and DUDBC/DLPIU has been realized
- Need of coordination among VDC secretary, political parties, NRA engineers and POs working in VDCs for smooth reconstruction and to address the issues raised.
- Inspection SOP/TOT training for POs engineers requesting DUDBC/DLPIU for providing the resource person for the training.
- Retrofitting training for NRA engineers as well as for POs engineers
- Road Standard of Road Department causing issue had better address with people (Citizen Awareness Forum, Local Political Leaders from each party present there and local people) of the very place for resettlement of victims and so as for other issues.

- Government should finalize at least five design and layout of RCC buildings for reducing time consuming and extra burden to engineers and minimize the cost of beneficiaries
- Progress report of each NGOs/INGOs in the lead of HRRP and DLSA with close coordination with DDRC, NRA, DUDBC, DDC, DAO should be published at least once a month publicly either by press release or by medias like FM, Newspaper and by other ways for making people outlook to NGOs and INGOs positive and feel the people need of INGOs/NGOs supports in future, however, it is very difficult task.
- DAO in coordination with District Federation of Contractors Association and Nepal Chamber of Commerce and Industry (FNCCI) must revise the wage rate for skilled and unskilled labours.
- One bay in construction allowed for construction of one storeys building only as two bay in construction is mandatory for construction of two or more than two storeys building.
- While providing the technical assistance from POs engineers like door to door technical assistance, it had better if POs have legal/official document like that of which needs for technical assistance providing by NRA engineers.
- There should be formed coordination committee forming of Social Leaders, Political Leaders, VDC Secretary, NRA engineers, Skilled Masons and Members from reconstruction committee formed in ward level in each VDCs to address issues raised and for advocacy in district as well as in center.
- Height of floor must be as written in guideline and SMM with RCC band is to be practiced instead of attic band.
- Technical Inspection Team must be strict in implementing the prescribed standards or Technical Assistance teams must be notified of the approved leverage in the standards.
- Recommendation for second installment should be done very soon in all VDCs taking the best construction example in that VDC. This will encourage the beneficiaries who haven't started construction to take those houses as a model house.

Annexes

Annex 1: Registration of Participants

S N	Full Name	Organization	Designation	Contact Number	Email
1	Ved Prashad Gaudel	NRA	NRA Head	9843935523	vgprasadgaudel123@gmail.com
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7	Ayush Baskota	NSET	District Coordinator	9851230832	abaskota@nset.org.np
8	Anita Gyawali	Save the Children	Shelter Technical Officer	9841716135	anita.gyawali@savethechildren
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10	Samundra Adhikari	Nepal Red Cross	Community Trainer	9857044503	adsamundra@gmail.com
11	Siddhartha Sharma	GIZ/HRRP	DC	9851121071	Siddhartha.sharma@giz.de
12	Goverdhan Sunar	GIZ/HRRP	IM	9851121071	goverdhan.sunar@giz.de
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14	Buddha Thakuri	GIZ/HRRP	IMA	9841961829	lm.nuwakot@hrrpnepal.org

Annex 2: Participants Attendance

One Day Technical Workshop

Current Status Of Technical Assistance in Reconstruction and It's Challenges

DATE: February 7, 2017

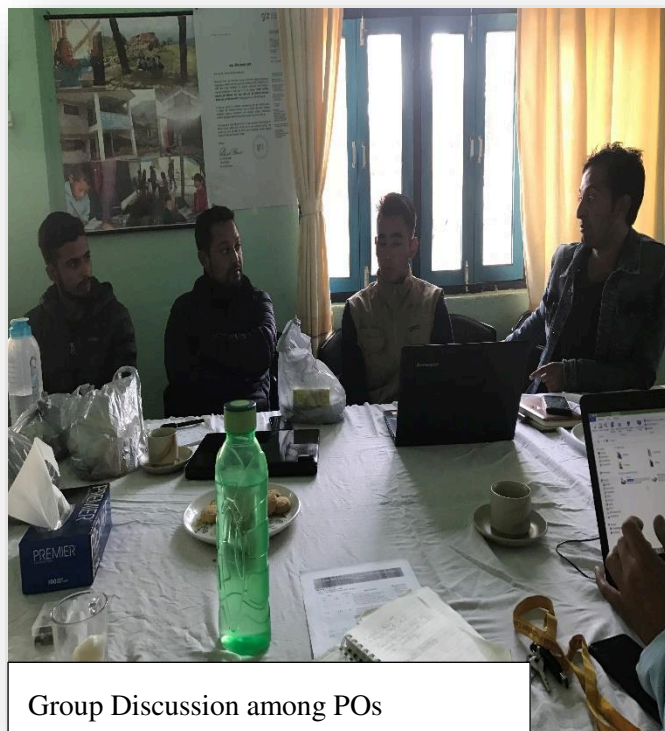
VENUE: GIZ/RPN

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2	Rajendra Gautam	World Renew	Project Manager	9801009649	wr.nepal.rgautam@gmail.com	
3	Ujjwal Nanda Vaidya	ASF Nepal	Program Manager	9801115510	ujwal-nv@yahoo.com	
4	Abinash Aryal	ASF Nepal	Site Supervisor		nepa.abinash@gmail.com	
5	Rabin Singh Maharjan	Habitat for Humanity Nepal	Monitoring & Evaluation	9801073686	rsmaharjan@habitatnepal.org	
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Annex 3: Photographs



NRA Head speaking on Govt publications



Group Discussion among POs



Presentation from PO



Group Photo with NRA head